ENTERPRISE UZBEKISTAN

Executive strategic advisory report

Regulatory Sandbox: International Benchmarking and Design Report

What has worked internationally, what the evidence shows, and the sandbox operating model Enterprise Uzbekistan should launch

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STATUS Decision-support draft. Figures are sourced to the bibliography; read the evidence-status note on the next page before relying on any number.

LANGUAGE English

About this report: evidence status and how to read it

Evidence status: read before relying on any figure

What was done. Live web research on 20 October 2026 across regulator, government, multilateral and academic sources, followed by structuring into case studies, a design and a plan.

Limitation that affects every chapter. The research environment blocked direct access to most primary hosts (including fca.org.uk, mas.gov.sg, bis.org, weforum.org, dfsa.ae and lex.uz). Figures were therefore taken from search-engine summaries of the cited primary pages, or from secondary sources where stated. **No primary PDF was opened.** Each figure carries the source of the primary page it points to; none has been checked against that page's full text.

Legal framework. The Enterprise Uzbekistan provisions in Chapter 5 come from news and law-firm reports and from EUz's own working files. **The official texts of Decree UP-233 and the Constitutional Law were not read.** Nothing in this report is a confirmed legal position. The fit-gap matrix (Section 5.6) is a checklist for counsel, not a legal opinion.

What leadership should do with this. Use the conclusions to choose a direction; run the verification sprint in Annex D before any figure is quoted externally or any rule is drafted.

Evidence tags used throughout

Tag	Meaning	Treatment in this report
R	Regulator- or government-reported result	Reported as stated, with year and cohort. Not independently verified.
I	Independent evaluation (academic, multilateral, independent review)	Given most weight.
P	Participant-, vendor- or convener-reported	Flagged as such; never used as a headline.
S	Secondary source only (news, law-firm note, trade press)	Used for context; marked where a figure depends on it.
T	Target or intention, not an achieved result	Never presented as a result.
D	Derived arithmetic from reported numbers (e.g. admitted / applied)	Shown with its inputs; definitions differ across programmes.
A	Analyst interpretation or EUz recommendation	Set apart from facts in every case card (sections D and E).

Rules applied. Numbers are given with reporting period and cohort. Where a metric could not be verified it is marked "Not verified" or omitted from headline statistics. Management planning assumptions (service levels, team size, targets) are labelled as assumptions and are not EUz baselines. Suggested participants and regulators are illustrations, not commitments.

Source codes. References such as [S7] point to the bibliography in Annex E, which lists each URL.

Abbreviations used

Abbreviation	Meaning	Abbreviation	Meaning
ADGM	Abu Dhabi Global Market	KPI	Key performance indicator
AI	Artificial intelligence	MAS	Monetary Authority of Singapore
API	Application programming interface	MLETR	UNCITRAL Model Law on Electronic Transferable Records
BIS	Bank for International Settlements	MoU	Memorandum of understanding
DFSA	Dubai Financial Services Authority	NAPP	National Agency for Perspective Projects (Uzbekistan)
EUz	Enterprise Uzbekistan	OECD	Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development
FCA	Financial Conduct Authority (UK)	Ofgem	Office of Gas and Electricity Markets (UK)
FSRA	Financial Services Regulatory Authority (ADGM)	SAMA	Saudi Central Bank
GFIN	Global Financial Innovation Network	SLA	Service level agreement (time commitment)
GRIP	Global Regulatory Innovation Platform (WEF)	UNCITRAL	UN Commission on International Trade Law
HKMA	Hong Kong Monetary Authority	WD	Working days
ICO	Information Commissioner's Office (UK)	WEF	World Economic Forum

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1. Executive summary: the evidence supports a lean, guidance-first sandbox with a published decision clock

Five international findings

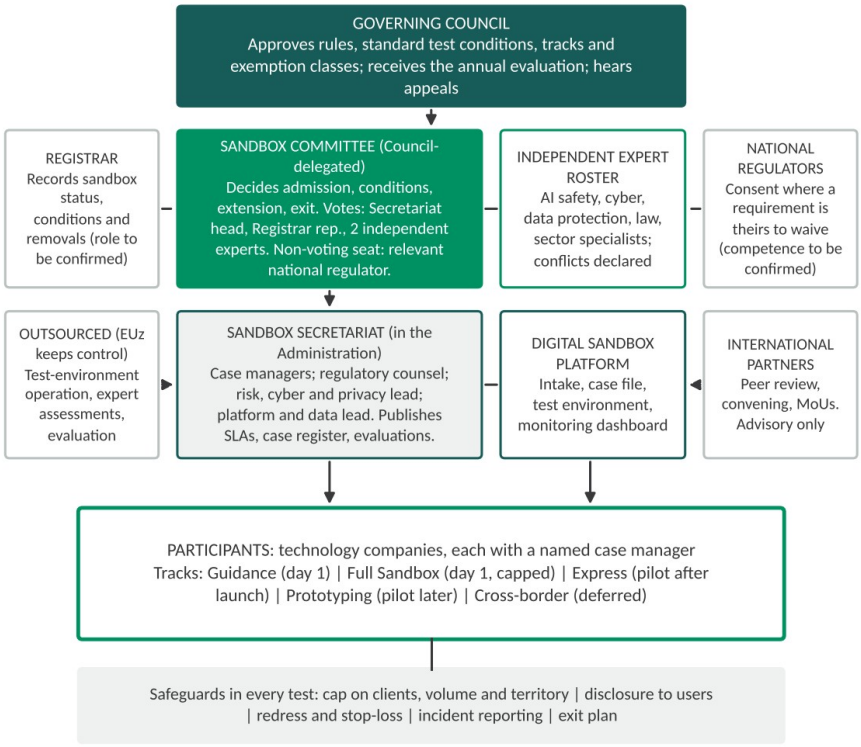
1. **The clearest measurable outcome is conversion to a licence, and it depends on the exit design.** The Monetary Authority of Singapore (MAS) reports 15 of 19 accepted firms graduated and were licensed (Oct 2025, R) [S7]; the Saudi Central Bank (SAMA) reported 18 graduates among 45 permitted firms (May 2023, R) [S22]; the Dubai Financial Services Authority (DFSA) reported only 3 exits among 51 accepted firms (Jun 2021, R) [S14].
2. **Independent evidence of commercial benefit exists for one programme.** Research by the Bank for International Settlements (BIS) on the UK sandbox links entry to about 15% more capital raised and about a 50% higher probability of raising capital (data 2014-2019, I) [S2]. Effects are strongest for small, young firms.
3. **Most applicants need guidance, not exemptions.** In the first window of Ofgem, the UK energy regulator, 30 expressions of interest produced 3 sandboxes; 22 received feedback only because no specific regulatory barrier existed (R) [S6]. The UK Information Commissioner's Office (ICO) has no power to waive the law and still published exit reports [S5].
4. **Fast tracks and incentive tracks are the least proven parts.** MAS's 21-day Express response is a stated target with no published attainment rate (T) [S8]; its Sandbox Plus grant track had zero approvals by Oct 2025 (R) [S7]; the standard track's median is about 3 months [S7].
5. **Cross-border and multi-regulator testing is hard to execute.** The pilot of the Global Financial Innovation Network (GFIN) drew 44 applications across 17 regulators and shortlisted 8 firms; none began testing (R, Jan 2020) [S15]. The UAE TradeTech sandbox, convened by the World Economic Forum (WEF), ran 8 start-ups with 4 UAE regulators, but results are convener-reported (P) [S11].

Artificial intelligence (AI) is now the growth frontier: the generative-AI sandbox of the Hong Kong Monetary Authority (HKMA) went from 15 use cases (Dec 2024) to 36 in Sandbox++ (Aug 2026) [S21], but admissions are not outcomes, and no AI sandbox has yet published verified results.

Ten recommendations for Enterprise Uzbekistan

#	Recommendation (action, owner, output)	Evidence base
1	**Launch two tracks on day one**: a Guidance Track and a capped Full Sandbox. Council decides; Sandbox Secretariat runs. Output: operating track rules.	Ofgem 22 of 30; ICO; MAS standard track
2	**Create a Sandbox Secretariat and a Council-delegated Sandbox Committee** with independent experts. Output: decision rights and a case register.	FCA, MAS, DFSA operate dedicated teams
3	**Publish a decision clock** (planning-assumption service levels, SLAs) and report attainment quarterly. Output: SLA schedule and dashboard.	MAS publishes a median but not Express attainment
4	**Make regulatory mapping the core product**: map every applicable rule and name who must consent. EUz does not waive other regulators' requirements. Output: mapping memo per case.	GFIN failure; SAMA/regulator-gated models
5	**Define exit before admission**: each test plan states the evidence that would qualify the firm for a permanent route. No automatic licence. Output: exit routes.	DFSA 3 exits of 51; MAS 15 of 19
6	**Stand up a minimum digital sandbox** with synthetic data, application programming interfaces (APIs) and a secure environment for AI and data pilots. Output: platform MVP.	FCA Digital Sandbox evaluation
7	**Select four pilots** (Section 7): AI-agent assurance; electronic trade documents with AI screening; privacy-preserving data exchange; AI regulatory reporting.	TradeTech, HKMA, Spain AI sandbox
8	**Pilot Express and Regulation Prototyping only after the first cohort**; defer Cross-border tests to year two. Output: track sequencing.	MAS Plus unused; GFIN; Japan reforms
9	**Use WEF as convener and peer reviewer**, with defined deliverables; keep decisions, rules, risk and regulator relations inside EUz (Section 6).	WEF results are self-reported; outputs of its Global Regulatory Innovation Platform (GRIP) not yet delivered
10	**Run a legal verification sprint** on the official texts before rules are drafted (Annex D). Output: verified legal baseline.	No official text was read for this report

Proposed Sandbox architecture



Analyst design (A). Governing Council sets rules; a Council-delegated Sandbox Committee decides admissions; a small Secretariat runs cases and a minimum digital platform; national regulators consent wherever a requirement is theirs to waive. Detail in Section 5.1.

What leadership needs to approve (detail in Section 8.5)

(1) The two-track launch and the sequencing of later tracks; (2) delegation of admission decisions to a Sandbox Committee, subject to counsel's confirmation of Council powers; (3) a Sandbox Secretariat and budget envelope to be sized; (4) the legal verification sprint and drafting of Sandbox Rules; (5) the four-pilot portfolio and selection criteria; (6) the scope of WEF engagement.

Timing. Press reports put the Constitutional Law's entry into force at 21 January 2027 (S) [S27], about 93 days after this report. The 90-day plan in Section 8.1 is designed to fit that window.

2. International results at a glance: documented results are real but modest, and concentrated in licensing, funding and guidance

Exhibit 1. Strongest documented results and equally important documented gaps (as reported; primary pages not opened)

15 of 19
MAS accepted firms that graduated and were licensed
Singapore, as at Oct 2025. R [S7]

+15% | +50%
Capital raised | probability of raising capital after UK sandbox entry
UK, data 2014-2019. I [S2]

172 of 629
FCA applications accepted, 2016 to Dec 2023
UK. R [S3]; D: 27%

about 3 months
MAS median time from submission to outcome, incl. applicant response
Singapore, Oct 2025. R [S7]

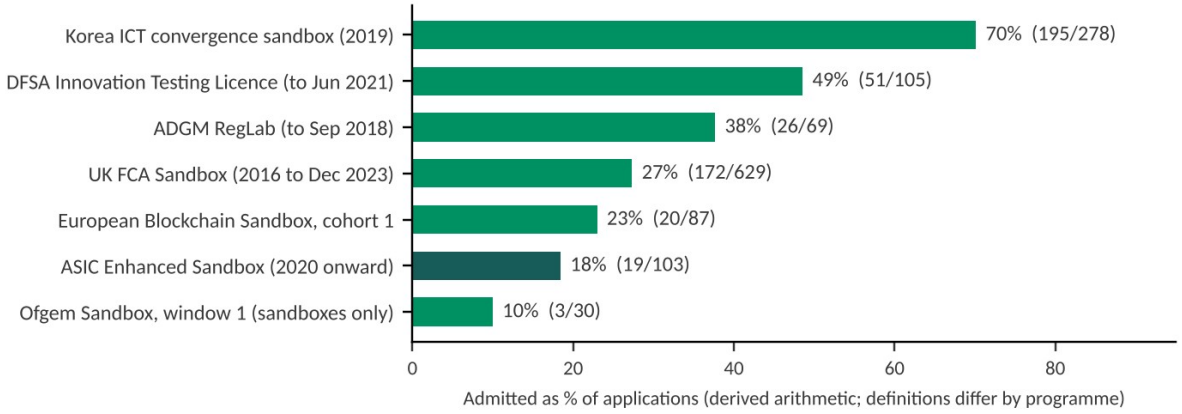
0
Sandbox Plus approvals (grant track, from Jan 2022)
Singapore, as at Oct 2025. R [S7]

0 of 8
GFIN shortlisted firms that began cross-border testing
17 regulators, Jan 2020. R [S15]

36
HKMA Sandbox++ use cases, from about 100 proposals
Hong Kong, 27 Aug 2026. R [S21]

60
Use cases in European Blockchain Sandbox, 3 cohorts, no legal exemption
EU, final report 11 Feb 2026. R [S17]

Exhibit 2. Selectivity varies widely: admission rates range from 10% to 70% across programmes



Derived (D) from reported counts: FCA [S3]; DFSA [S14]; ADGM [S13]; European Blockchain Sandbox cohort 1 [S17]; ASIC (independent review, via press) [S24]; Ofgem window 1 [S6]; Korea ICT convergence 2019 [S23]. Definitions differ (some count sandboxes, some admissions to testing), periods differ, and ASIC's source is a press account of a review. Read as a range, not a ranking.

Exhibit 3. International performance scorecard: published data only, definitions differ by row

Jurisdiction / programme	Companies / pilots	Commercialisation	Processing time	Regulatory outcomes	Key mechanism
UK FCA Sandbox (2016)	629 applied, 172 accepted to Dec 2023 [S3]	Cohort 1: about 90% moved toward launch; at least 40% invested (FCA-reported) [S1]. I: +15% capital [S2]	No SLA found	Not verified (tools used: waivers, no-action letters)	Live testing with restricted authorisation
Singapore MAS Sandbox / Express / Plus	19 accepted [S7]	15 graduated and licensed [S7]	Median about 3 months; Express target 21 days (T) [S7][S8]	Not disclosed	Three tracks; Plus: grant up to S$500k at 50% co-funding
UAE ADGM RegLab (2016)	26 admitted of 69, to Sep 2018 [S13]	Not verified	Not disclosed	Not verified	Conditional authorisation in cohorts
UAE DFSA ITL (2017)	51 accepted of 105 (Jun 2021); 67 of 130 hosted (Jul 2022) [S14]	3 exits of 51 accepted (Jun 2021) [S14]	Not disclosed	Not verified	Testing licence up to 12 months; open window from 2022

Jurisdiction / programme	Companies / pilots	Commercialisation	Processing time	Regulatory outcomes	Key mechanism
UK ICO Sandbox (2019)	10 chosen of about 64-65 [S5]	Not applicable	Not disclosed	Published exit reports; no legal derogation [S5]	Guidance without exemptions
UK Ofgem Sandbox (2016-17)	30 EOIs, 3 sandboxes, 22 feedback only (window 1) [S6]	Not verified	Not disclosed	Rule-change count not verified	Triage: advice first, derogation second
EU Blockchain Sandbox (2023)	87 applied, 20 admitted (cohort 1); 60 use cases in 3 cohorts [S17]	Not tracked	Not applicable	>50 regulators in cohort 1; best-practice reports [S17]	Non-binding cross-border dialogue
Japan cross-sector sandbox (2018)	33 plans, 152 entities certified, Mar 2025 [S20]	Not verified	Not disclosed	Panasonic PLC case led to a law revision (S); total not verified	Project-specific exemption with data collection
HKMA FSS and GenAI sandbox	FSS: 234 cumulative initiatives, end-2021 [S21]. GenAI: 15, 27, then 36 use cases [S21]	Not verified	Not disclosed	Not verified	Supervisory sandbox; AI cohorts with tech partners
Saudi SAMA (2018)	45 permitted, May 2023 [S22]	18 graduated, May 2023 [S22]	Not disclosed	Not verified	Tiered permission; regulator-led exit
South Korea (financial, 2019)	>300 designated, Mar 2024 (a Jun 2026 press report says 1,072: unreconciled) [S23]	KRW 6.03tn investment, 2,220 jobs (FSC-reported) [S23]	Review up to 120 days (S) [S23]	Not verified	Statutory time-limited designation
Australia ASIC enhanced (2020)	103 applied, 19 accepted [S24]	1 ex-participant obtained a licence; of 16 that exited, 12 shut (press account of review) [S24]	Not disclosed	Not verified	24 months, exposure caps
WEF-UAE TradeTech (2024)	8 start-ups, 4 UAE regulators (P) [S11]	Not verified	Not applicable	Not verified	Convened multi-regulator testing
GFIN cross-border pilot (2018-20)	44 applied, 17 regulators, 8 shortlisted [S15]	0 began testing [S15]	Not applicable	Lessons-learned report [S15]	Single application to many regulators

"Not verified" means no figure was found in the sources reached; "Not disclosed" means none appears to be published. Rows are not ranked. Full programme detail is in Annex A.

What the evidence actually tells us

1. **Outcomes are measured at the licence gate and the funding gate, rarely at the consumer or cost gate.** No source reviewed publishes audited compliance-cost or time savings. EUz should collect participant-estimated baselines from the first cohort and label them as estimates.
2. **Admission is a signal.** The UK evidence is a funding and certification effect; selection is non-random and the FCA itself said in 2017 it was too early to judge overall impact [S1][S2]. A weakly selected cohort would damage the signal EUz is trying to create.
3. **Throughput is small everywhere.** MAS reported 19 firms accepted since 2016 (the reply may span all tracks); Japan certified 33 plans by 2025; the DFSA exits were 3 of 51 at its 2021 count. Planning for dozens of simultaneous pilots would be out of line with the evidence.
4. **Where programmes underperform, the cause is usually design, not demand.** Unused Sandbox Plus, a failed multi-regulator pilot, falling Korean ICT applications (110 to 67 over two years, S [S23]) and an Australian regime where 12 of 16 exiting firms shut down (S [S24]) all point to eligibility, coordination or exit design.
5. **Guidance and published reports are the lowest-cost, best-evidenced outputs.** Ofgem, the ICO, the European Blockchain Sandbox and Spain's AI sandbox each produced reusable guidance without relying on legal exemptions [S5] [S6][S17][S19].

3. Selected international success stories: eight programmes, each tied to one EUz design decision

Each card follows the same logic: what was introduced, what was measured, why it matters, what EUz should take, and one design decision. Sections A to C are facts as reported; D and E are analysis and recommendation. Every figure is as reported by the cited source and was not checked against the primary document.

3.1 UK FCA Regulatory Sandbox: admission works as a funding signal, so EUz must measure outcomes from day one

United Kingdom | Financial Conduct Authority | launched 2016 | operational

A. What they introduced	Live testing with real consumers under tailored restrictions: restricted authorisation, individual guidance, waivers and no-enforcement-action letters. Consumer safeguards stay in place. Cohort-based at first, later always-open.
B. Verified results	- Cohorts 1-2: 146 applications, 50 accepted, 41 tested (to Oct 2017, R) [S1] - Cohort 1: about 90% moved toward wider launch; at least 40% received investment (FCA-reported, R) [S1] - 2016 to Dec 2023: 629 applications, 172 accepted (R; D: 27%); FY2023/24: 43 applied, 4 accepted; FY2024/25: 52 applied, 16 accepted [S3] - Independent: entry linked to about +15% capital raised and about +50% probability of raising capital; positive survival and patenting effects, stronger for small and young firms (UK data 2014-2019, I) [S2]
C. Why it matters	The measured effect is a certification effect: regulatory comfort lowers investors' information risk. It is not evidence of better consumer outcomes, and entry is non-random. The FCA said in 2017 that it was too early to judge overall impact. Per-cohort figures differ across sources.
D. Lesson for EUz	A sandbox seat is valued because it signals scrutiny. EUz's signal is only as strong as its selection and its published reasoning.
E. EUz design decision	Write outcome tracking into every test agreement: funding raised, licence status and survival at 12 and 24 months, reported to the Secretariat. Owner: Secretariat. Output: first evidence-based annual report. No legal change needed.
F. Source	[S1] FCA lessons-learned report (Oct 2017); [S2] BIS Working Paper 901; [S3] FCA FOI response (May 2026).

3.2 Singapore MAS: the licence pathway works; an unused incentive track is a design failure

Singapore | Monetary Authority of Singapore | 2016 (Express 2019, Plus 2022) | operational

A. What they introduced	Three tracks: a standard sandbox for first movers; Sandbox Express for predefined low-risk activities (up to 9 months of testing, a stated 21-day response endeavour); and Sandbox Plus from Jan 2022 for early adopters, with grants up to S$500,000 at 50% co-funding.
B. Verified results	- 15 of 19 firms accepted into the sandbox graduated and were licensed; one later ceased operating (Oct 2025, R; scope across tracks to be verified) [S7] - Median processing time about 3 months, including applicant response time (Oct 2025, R) [S7] - Express: 21 days is a target (T); no attainment rate published [S8] - Sandbox Plus: no approvals as at Oct 2025, because most applications used technologies already in Singapore (R) [S7]
C. Why it matters	Conversion to licence reflects a defined exit into an existing licensing regime. The unused Plus track suggests eligibility or incentive design did not match demand; causal attribution is not established.
D. Lesson for EUz	Copy the predefined-conditions idea of Express, narrowly. Do not build a grant or incentive track before demand evidence exists. Publish what is actually achieved, not only the target.
E. EUz design decision	After cohort 1, define two predefined low-risk categories with Council-approved standard conditions, and commit to a published decision time (planning assumption: 21 days from a complete application, matching MAS's endeavour), with quarterly reporting of attainment. Owner: Secretariat; approval: Council.
F. Source	[S7] MAS written parliamentary reply, 14 Oct 2025; [S8] MAS Sandbox Express consultation (2018); [S9] MAS Sandbox Plus release (2021).

3.3 UK FCA Digital Sandbox: synthetic data speeds development, but data quality decides its value

United Kingdom | FCA | pilots 2020-2022; AI initiatives 2025 | pilots completed; later programmes ongoing

A. What they introduced	A cloud testing environment with synthetic datasets, APIs and an observation layer. No live consumers and no authorisation relief. Created after a three-week DataSprint in Jul-Aug 2020 with 120 participants.
B. Verified results	- Pilot 1 (Oct 2020-Feb 2021): SME finance, fraud, vulnerable customers. Pilot 2 (Oct 2021-Mar 2022): sustainable finance. 28 organisations took part (R) [S4] - FCA evaluation: the vast majority said the environment accelerated development; synthetic data was the most valued feature, but only about half said it met expectations (R, participant survey) [S4] - Permanent status and later participant numbers: not verified - Ongoing, no outcomes yet: Supercharged Sandbox with Nvidia from Oct 2025 (S); AI Live Testing, first cohort of seven named firms announced Dec 2025, evaluation planned after 12 months (T) [S33]
C. Why it matters	Access to data and APIs was among barriers firms reported to the FCA in 2017 [S1]. The environment removes that barrier without regulatory risk.
D. Lesson for EUz	Offer synthetic data and a secure test environment as a day-one service for AI and data pilots, and agree a data-quality specification with participants.
E. EUz design decision	Build a minimum Digital Sandbox in months 2-6: isolated tenancy, synthetic datasets for two pilot domains, an API gateway and logging. Owner: platform and data lead. Success test set with the first pilot's participants, not assumed.
F. Source	[S4] FCA Digital Sandbox pilot; [S33] AI Live Testing and Supercharged Sandbox reports (trade press).

3.4 UK ICO Sandbox: a regulator with no power to waive the law still produced published guidance

United Kingdom | Information Commissioner's Office | beta 2019 | operational; statutory option under review

A. What they introduced	Free, bespoke engagement with ICO staff on novel personal-data projects. The output is a published exit report setting out the regulator's views. There is no legal derogation.
B. Verified results	- Ten organisations chosen from about 64-65 applications (2019 beta; sources differ) (S) [S5] - Nine of the ten exited between Jun 2020 and Mar 2021 despite pandemic delays (S) [S5] - Later exit reports include Our Future Health (Oct 2023) and Meta (Sep 2025) (S) [S5] - Beta review (self-assessed by ICO): participants reported access to expertise and more confidence in finished products [S5] - A Jul 2026 trade-press item says the ICO found a statutory sandbox feasible subject to conditions (S; primary report not checked)
C. Why it matters	Published exit reports turn one bilateral engagement into reusable regulatory guidance. Limits: small cohorts, high staff effort, self-reported benefits.
D. Lesson for EUz	The Guidance Track needs no exemption power and can be live before rules are final. It should end in a published position.
E. EUz design decision	Every Guidance Track case closes with a short written regulatory position, published in anonymised form within a planning-assumption 30 working days. Owner: regulatory counsel. Output: a growing public position library.
F. Source	[S5] ICO Sandbox beta review and previous-participants page.

3.5 ADGM RegLab and DFSA ITL: Gulf on-ramps admit many firms, but the exit pathway is the bottleneck

United Arab Emirates | ADGM FSRA (2016) and DFSA (May 2017) | operational; latest counts not verified

A. What they introduced	ADGM RegLab: time-limited conditional authorisation for fintech cohorts. DFSA Innovation Testing Licence: up to 12 months of testing with test-plan targets; firms must show they can meet full authorisation requirements to exit. The DFSA moved from cohorts to an open window in 2022.
B. Verified results	- RegLab: 26 admitted of 69 applications from 20 countries; cohorts of 5, 11 and 10 (to Sep 2018, R) [S13] - ITL: 105 applicants, 51 accepted, 5 operating, 3 exited, 7 in-principle (Jun 2021, R); 130 applicants, 67 hosted (Jul 2022, R) [S14] - First DFSA graduate: Sarwa (robo-adviser), Nov 2018, after nearly 12 months (R) [S14] - Not verified: any ADGM figure after 2018; DFSA counts after 2022; licence conversion for RegLab
C. Why it matters	Applications rose steadily (41, 82, 105, 130 across reports), so regional demand for a testing on-ramp exists. Few exits by 2021 are consistent with the exit conditions and test durations (A: inference).
D. Lesson for EUz	EUz enters a market where established Gulf jurisdictions already attract applicants. Its difference must be non-financial emerging technology and speed, and it must define exit tests at the start.
E. EUz design decision	Require each test plan to state, at admission, the evidence that will qualify the participant for a permanent route (licence, existing-rules operation or revised regime), and track conversion. Owner: Sandbox Committee.
F. Source	[S13] ADGM announcements; [S14] DFSA Sarwa release and Finance Magnates report on ITL window.

3.6 WEF-UAE TradeTech Sandbox: a convened multi-regulator sandbox is feasible, but its outcome evidence is convener-reported

United Arab Emirates | WEF with UAE government and Abu Dhabi DED | MoU Jan 2024; report Oct 2025 | operational, results reported by convener

A. What they introduced	A sandbox for trade technology convened by the World Economic Forum under an MoU with the UAE and Abu Dhabi's economic department. UAE regulators supervised live tests; a vendor (NayaOne) supplied the technology platform (vendor-reported, P).
B. Verified results	- 8 start-ups and 4 UAE regulators (WEF report, 1 Oct 2025, P) [S11] - Themes tested: digital trade documents, self-sovereign identity, stablecoin payments, DeFi lending [S11] - Preliminary findings announced Apr 2025; about 21 months from MoU to report [S10][S11] - Unreconciled: a later WEF report lists more bodies (FSRA, DFSA, CBUAE, MoFT, ADDED) than "4 regulators" (S) - Not verified: per-firm outcomes, licences, volumes, any independent evaluation
C. Why it matters	The documented value is coordination: one programme spanning trade, payments and identity under several authorities. Commercial results are not evidenced.
D. Lesson for EUz	A convener can reduce coordination cost for multi-authority pilots, provided outcomes are reported per participant and unresolved issues are published.
E. EUz design decision	Run the TradeTech pilot (Pilot 2, Section 7) under one test plan with a named lead authority, and make per-participant outcome reporting a condition of any partner's role. Owner: Sandbox Committee.
F. Source	[S10] WAM launch release; [S11] WEF, Advancing Digital Trade (Oct 2025); [S32] NayaOne release.

3.7 HKMA GenAI Sandbox: an AI-specific sandbox can scale quickly when it pairs institutions with technology partners

Hong Kong SAR | HKMA with Cyberport | launched Sep 2024 | operational; outcome data not verified

A. What they introduced	A non-statutory sandbox that pairs banks with technology partners to test generative-AI use cases. Cohorts were announced in Dec 2024 and Oct 2025; Sandbox++ (Aug 2026) extends to securities and insurance and to agentic AI.
B. Verified results	- Cohort 1 (Dec 2024): 15 use cases, 10 banks, 4 tech partners, from more than 40 proposals (R) [S21] - Cohort 2 (Oct 2025): 27 use cases, 20 banks, 14 tech partners, from more than 60 proposals (R) [S21] - Sandbox++ (27 Aug 2026): 36 use cases, 30 financial institutions, 27 tech partners, from about 100 proposals (R) [S21] - Not verified: production deployments, risk findings or supervisory outcomes. Earlier FSS: 234 cumulative initiatives by end-2021 [S21]
C. Why it matters	Repeat cohorts with rising proposals show demand for AI testing. The counts are admissions, not results.
D. Lesson for EUz	Start with a single themed cohort and expand in rounds only after review, using partner pairing to lift quality.
E. EUz design decision	Run the first Full Sandbox round as one themed cohort (AI assurance) of three to four projects, publish the call openly, and decide on a larger round 2 at the month-9 review. Owner: Sandbox Committee.
F. Source	[S21] HKMA press releases (Dec 2024, Oct 2025, Aug 2026); Hong Kong LegCo research paper (Feb 2022).

3.8 EU sandboxes: dialogue at scale produces guidance, while the power to grant exemptions remains absent

European Union | Blockchain Sandbox (2023-2026); AI Act sandboxes (Arts 57-59); Spain pilot | mixed status

A. What they introduced	The European Blockchain Regulatory Sandbox: free, non-binding cross-border dialogues between projects and regulators, 20 projects per year. The AI Act requires national AI sandboxes (Arts 57-59); Spain ran a first national pilot, which closed on 12 Jun 2026.
B. Verified results	- Blockchain cohort 1: 87 applications, 20 use cases, more than 50 regulators or authorities involved (R) [S17] - Final report 11 Feb 2026 draws on 60 use cases across three cohorts (R) [S17] - Spain: 11 systems completed per the official release; secondary sources say 12 selected from 44 applications (unreconciled); outputs: technical guides, a checklist tool, a results report (Sep 2026) [S19] - AI Act: national sandbox deadline moved from 2 Aug 2026 to 2 Aug 2027 by the Digital Omnibus (S: law-firm notes; verify in EUR-Lex); adoption of the implementing act on sandbox arrangements not verified [S18]
C. Why it matters	Structured dialogue yields shared interpretations at scale. No quantified compliance-time or cost outcomes were published in the sources reached.
D. Lesson for EUz	A published best-practice report per cohort is a low-cost output that builds credibility as a rule-maker for emerging technology.
E. EUz design decision	Commit to a Regulatory Insights Report within a planning-assumption 60 days of each cohort closing, approved by the Council and used as input to rule prototyping. Owner: Secretariat.
F. Source	[S17] European Blockchain Sandbox pages and final report; [S18] AI Act Omnibus notes; [S19] Spanish Government release and results report.

4. Innovative mechanisms and interesting cases: proven tools are modest; the novel ones are mostly unmeasured

4.1 Fourteen mechanisms, with the strength of evidence stated

Status key: **Proven** = operational with documented results; **Operational, no impact data** = running but no reliable results found; **Experimental** = early or ongoing; **Proposed** = announced, not implemented. Innovation alone is not treated as evidence of success.

Exhibit 4. Mechanism cards: international example, verified result, value and requirements for EUz

Mechanism	International example	Verified result (type)	Value for EUz	Implementation requirements	Status
1 Express / fast-track	MAS Sandbox Express (2019)	21-day response is a target (T); attainment unpublished; standard median about 3 months [S7][S8]	Predictable decision for low-risk cases	Predefined categories; Council-approved standard conditions; published attainment	Operational, no impact data
2 Guidance without exemptions	ICO Sandbox; Ofgem Innovation Link	Ofgem w1: 22 of 30 needed feedback only (R) [S6]; ICO exit reports [S5]	Lowest cost; usable before rules are final	Case manager; counsel; publication policy	Proven
3 Multi-track	MAS three tracks; Uzbek Central Bank three-track draft (announced)	Plus: 0 approvals (R) [S7]; Central Bank draft not yet in force [S29]	Matches effort to risk	Clear entry test per track; start with two tracks	Operational, mixed
4 Cross-sector sandbox	Japan (2018, permanent 2021); Korea ICT convergence	Japan: 33 plans, 152 entities, Mar 2025 (R) [S20]. Korea ICT: applications fell 110 to 67 over two years, spread over six ministries (S) [S23]	One door for emerging tech spanning ministries	Power to convene regulators; single case file	Operational; reform count not verified
5 Time-limited exemptions	Korea Financial Special Act (2019); Japan	Korea: >300 services designated by Mar 2024; 1,072 per a Jun 2026 press report (unreconciled) [S23]	Legal certainty for the test period	Statutory basis; caps; stop-loss; defined term	Operational
6 Regulation prototyping	Japan: Panasonic PLC project led to a law revision	One reform case (S); total reforms not verified [S20]	Turns tests into rules	Council rule-making route; pilot-to-rule note	Operational, no reliable counts
7 Graduation	MAS 15 of 19; SAMA 18 of 45; DFSA 3 exits of 51	R [S7][S22][S14]; Australia: 1 licence among 16 exits (S) [S24]	Defines success and avoids limbo	Exit routes set at admission; licensing partners	Proven, wide variance
8 Cross-border corridors	GFIN pilot; Singapore-Abu Dhabi MLETR transaction	GFIN: 0 of 8 began testing (R) [S15]; MLETR trade transaction piloted (S) [S34]	Reach and credibility abroad	Bilateral MoUs; mutual recognition; common test plan	Experimental
9 Digital sandbox, synthetic data	FCA Digital Sandbox	28 organisations; synthetic data most valued; about half said it met expectations (R) [S4]	Removes data-access barrier	Isolated environment; datasets; API gateway	Operational, limited data
10 AI model and live testing	HKMA GenAI; FCA AI Live Testing; Spain AI sandbox	HKMA: 15, 27, 36 use cases (R) [S21]; FCA outcomes pending (T) [S33]; Spain 11 completed [S19]	EUz mandate fit	Independent assurance expertise; test protocols	Experimental
11 Regulator-in-the-loop, multi-regulator	European Blockchain Sandbox; TradeTech	>50 regulators in cohort 1 (R) [S17]; 4 UAE regulators (P) [S11]	One test plan across authorities	Lead authority; consent protocol	Operational, no impact data
12 Investor access and funding link	UK sandbox (BIS); MAS Plus grants	+15% capital (I) [S2]; Plus: 0 approvals (R) [S7]	Commercial pull for participants	Outcome data; demo events; no grants initially	Proven (UK), unproven (grants)
13 Published exit and insight reports	ICO; European Blockchain Sandbox; Spain	Reports published for each cohort [S5][S17][S19]	Reputation as rule-maker	Confidentiality clauses; editorial process	Proven
14 Open-window intake	FCA always-open; DFSA open window (2022)	No impact data [S14]	Avoids cohort delays	Standing triage capacity	Operational, no impact data

Exhibit 5. International mechanism to EUz recommendation matrix

Mechanism	EUz recommendation (action, owner)	Timing
Guidance without exemptions	Run the Guidance Track as the front door; publish positions. Regulatory counsel.	Day 1
Published insight reports	One Council-approved report per cohort. Secretariat.	Day 1 (first report after cohort 1)
Graduation	Exit evidence stated in every test plan. Sandbox Committee.	Day 1

Mechanism	EUz recommendation (action, owner)	Timing
Digital sandbox, synthetic data	Minimum viable environment for AI and data pilots. Platform lead.	Day 1 (MVP), extend later
Time-limited exemptions	Use only for EUz-controlled requirements; consent for others. Council, regulators.	Day 1 (capped)
Multi-regulator testing	One test plan, named lead authority. Sandbox Committee.	Day 1 for Pilot 2 only
Express / fast-track	Two predefined categories after cohort 1. Council.	Pilot after month 6
Open-window intake	Rolling intake with monthly Committee meetings. Secretariat.	Day 1
AI model and live testing	Themed first cohort on AI assurance. Committee.	Day 1 (cohort 1)
Regulation prototyping	Pilot-to-rule notes first; formal track after review. Council.	Pilot after month 9
Investor access	Demo events; no grant track until demand is shown. Business development.	After month 6
Cross-sector sandbox	Single door with convening power over regulators. Council, regulators.	Day 1 (by design)
Multi-track	Two tracks first; add later as in Section 5.3. Council.	Phased
Cross-border corridors	MoUs only in year one; no tests. International affairs.	Defer to year 2

4.2 Seven real-world cases show what regulatory experimentation can enable

Each case states whether the outcome is completed or ongoing. "How EUz could apply this" is analysis, not a verified result.

Case	What happened (status)	How EUz could apply this
A. Sandbox to commercial launch	DFSA's first graduate, robo-adviser Sarwa, exited in Nov 2018 after nearly 12 months (completed, R) [S14]. MAS reports 15 of 19 accepted firms licensed (completed, R) [S7].	Count a launch only when a permanent route is granted; track time from admission to permanent status.
B. Reducing cost and uncertainty	Closest evidence: UK funding effect (I) [S2] and Ofgem's 22 of 30 cases resolved by feedback (completed, R) [S6]. **No audited compliance-cost saving was found in any programme reviewed (evidence gap).**	Record participant-estimated baseline cost and time at admission; label results as estimates.
C. Digital sandbox with synthetic data	FCA Digital Sandbox: two pilots, 28 organisations, synthetic data most valued (completed pilots, R) [S4]; later programmes ongoing [S33].	Provide synthetic data to AI and data pilots; test data quality with users.
D. Sandbox creating regulation	Japan's Panasonic PLC project contributed to a revision of the Electrical Appliance and Material Safety Act (completed, S); the regime became permanent in 2021 (law) [S20].	End every pilot with a Council note: rule change, guidance or none.
E. Multi-regulator testing	European Blockchain Sandbox cohort 1 involved more than 50 regulators (completed, R) [S17]; TradeTech used 4 UAE regulators (report published, P) [S11].	One test plan; one lead authority; defined consent steps.
F. Cross-border experiment	GFIN: 44 applications, 17 regulators, 8 shortlisted, none began testing (completed, R) [S15]. First MLETR-enabled Singapore-Abu Dhabi trade transaction piloted (S) [S34].	Defer cross-border tests; start with one bilateral MoU and recognition of a partner regulator's test decision.
G. New technology economy	HKMA GenAI sandbox (ongoing, R) [S21]; Spain AI sandbox (concluded Jun 2026, R) [S19]; FCA AI Live Testing (ongoing; no outcomes yet) [S33]. Press in Aug 2026 reported interest in testing drones and robotaxis in EUz (S) [S27].	AI assurance as cohort 1; treat autonomous vehicles as a watch item given physical-safety authorities.

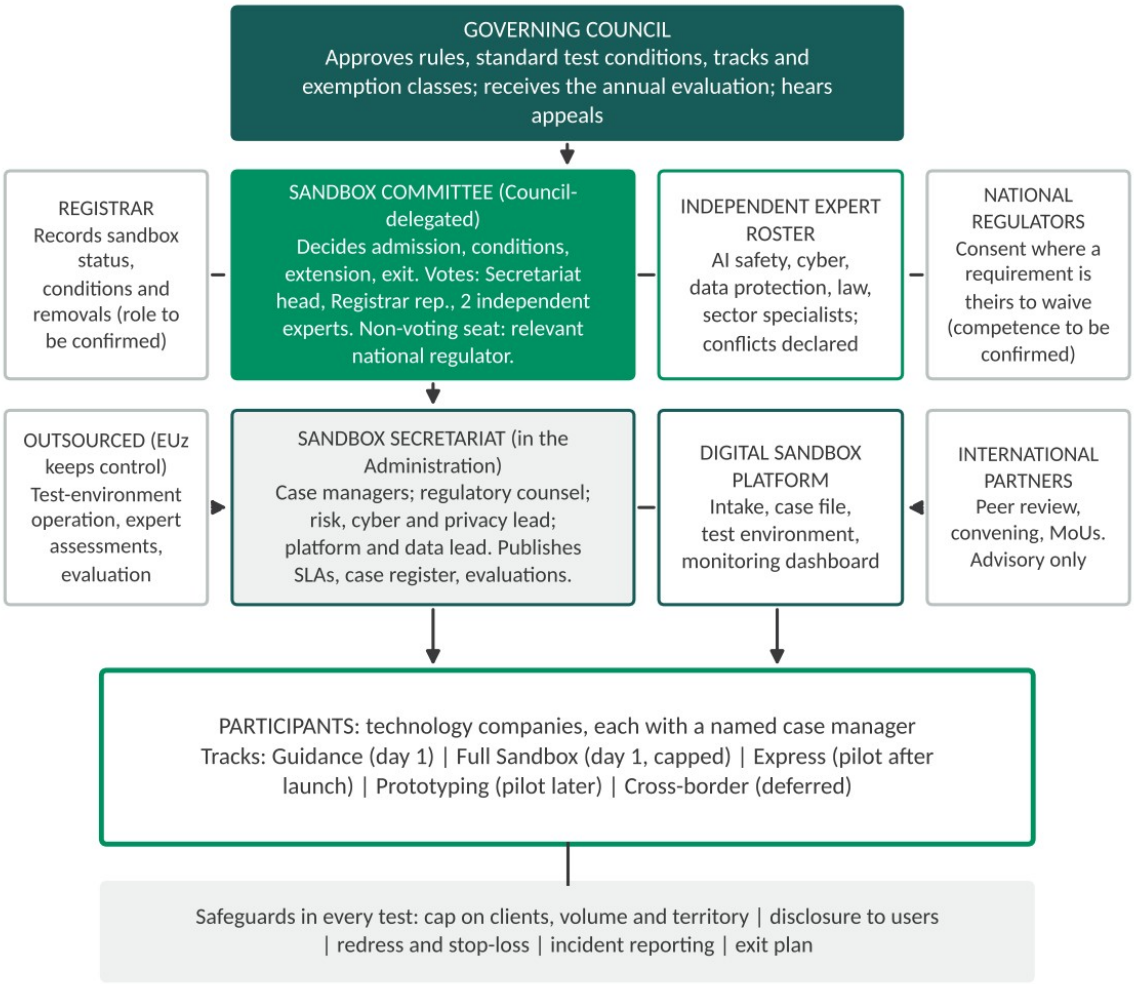
5. EUz Sandbox strategic design: a target operating model that is lean at launch and expands only on evidence

Basis for this chapter

Design choices rest on the international evidence in Chapters 2-4. Statements about Enterprise Uzbekistan's powers come from press reports of the Constitutional Law and Decree UP-233 and from EUz's own working files; **the official texts were not read**. Reported features: a sandbox of up to 12 months unless the Board sets another period, temporary exemptions from some statutory requirements, simplified licensing and access to the Center's infrastructure; procedures to follow in secondary regulations [S27]. EUz's working files model admission as decided by the Governing Council, limited to the product, clients, territory, term and volume in the decision, with no automatic right to commercial launch, and financial testing following the competent regulator's decision [S31]. **This design does not assume that EUz can waive any external regulator's requirement.**

5.1 Institutional architecture: ownership, decision rights and consent gates

Exhibit 6. Proposed EUz Sandbox architecture



Analyst design (A). Registrar role and national-regulator competences are to be confirmed against the official texts. Voting composition of the Sandbox Committee is a recommendation.

Exhibit 7. Governance and decision rights

Actor	Decides	Recommends / advises	Cannot do
Governing Council	Sandbox Rules; standard test conditions; which tracks open and when; classes of exemption within EUz's own powers; appeals; annual evaluation	Rule changes to national bodies	Waive a national regulator's requirement

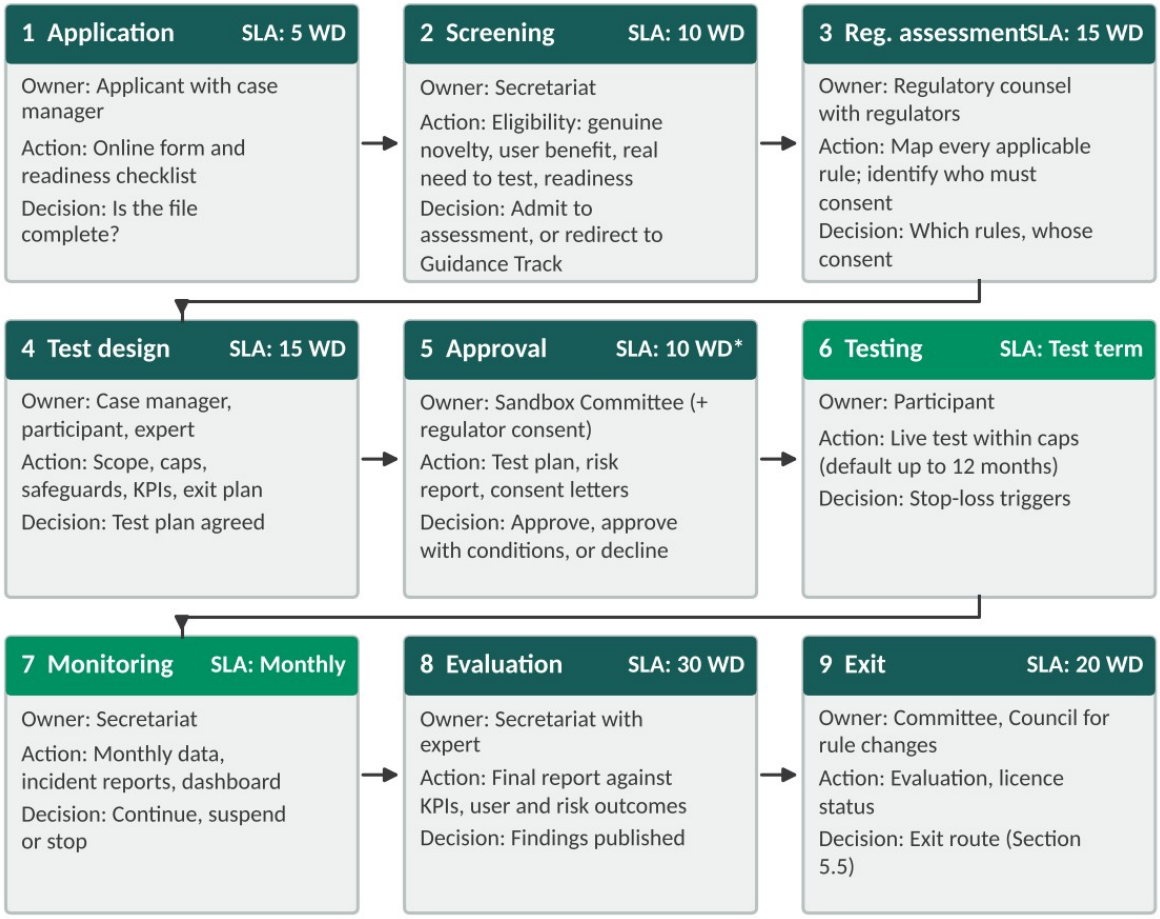
Actor	Decides	Recommends / advises	Cannot do
Sandbox Committee (delegated by Council, subject to counsel's confirmation)	Admission; test conditions; extension within the Board-set term; suspension; exit route	Standard-condition changes to Council	Admit without a regulatory mapping memo and any needed consent
Sandbox Secretariat	Eligibility screening; Guidance Track outputs; monitoring actions within rules (e.g. information requests)	Admission and exit recommendations; evaluation reports	Grant exemptions or approve tests
Independent experts (roster)	Nothing; advisory assessments of AI safety, cyber, data protection, law, sector	Risk ratings and test-design advice	Vote, except two seats on the Committee
Registrar	Records sandbox status, conditions and removals on the register (role to be confirmed [S31])	Status checks	Admit or exit participants
National regulators	Whether they consent where a requirement is theirs to waive	Test conditions in their remit	Be bound by EUz decisions without their consent
Participant	Whether to accept conditions	Test design	Operate outside the approved scope

Ownership, internal functions and outsourcing

- **Owner.** The EUz Administration owns the Sandbox through a dedicated **Sandbox Secretariat** with a named head. Planning assumption: a core team of about six (head, two case managers, regulatory counsel, risk and cyber lead, platform and data lead), scaled only after the first cohort. This is a management assumption, not a benchmark.
- **Keep internal:** eligibility decisions, case management, regulatory mapping, risk monitoring, publication, regulator relations.
- **May be outsourced under EUz control:** operation of the test environment, specialist technical assessments, and independent evaluation of the first cohort.
- **Independent experts** join at test design for AI, cyber and data-protection risk, and as two voting Committee members. Conflicts are declared and recorded.
- **National regulators must be involved** whenever a test touches a requirement they administer (for example financial services, securities, personal data, trade or transport). Competences must be confirmed case by case.
- **Risk, cyber and legal monitoring.** The Secretariat's risk lead reviews monthly participant data and incident reports; any material incident or stop-loss trigger goes to the Committee within a planning-assumption two working days.
- **Existing national sandboxes.** Uzbekistan already reports a Central Bank financial sandbox (Regulation 3391, Oct 2022), a capital-markets sandbox (PQ-255, 1 Oct 2025 to 1 Oct 2026) and a stablecoin pilot regime (PP-359) [S29][S30]. Press also reports a Cabinet of Ministers regime for a regulatory sandbox for businesses (Nov 2023) and a Law on Legal Experiments (27 Mar 2026) [S37][S38]; none of these texts was read. EUz should agree referral rules so a firm is not admitted twice or pushed between regimes.

5.2 Participant journey: nine stages with an owner, a decision and a clock

Exhibit 8. End-to-end participant journey



WD = working days. Service levels (SLAs) are management planning assumptions, not verified benchmarks. *The regulator's consent period is to be agreed by MoU. Express track: decision within 21 days of a complete application, matching the stated target of MAS.

Exhibit 9. Stage outputs and digital platform functionality

Stage	Required inputs	Output	Platform functionality
1 Application	Company profile, technology description, problem statement, readiness checklist	Complete file, case number	Online form; document upload; auto-completeness check
2 Screening	File; eligibility criteria (genuine novelty, user benefit, need to test, readiness)	Admit to assessment, or redirect to Guidance Track	Scoring-free checklist; reasons recorded
3 Regulatory assessment	Product description; rule library	Regulatory mapping memo: applicable rules, waivable by whom, consents needed	Rule library; consent tracker per authority
4 Test design	Mapping memo; participant plan	Test plan: scope, caps, safeguards, KPIs, exit evidence	Test-plan template; versioning
5 Approval	Test plan; risk report; consent letters	Committee decision with published reasons	Decision log; e-signature
6 Testing	Approved conditions	Live or synthetic-data test within caps	Secure environment; API gateway; logging
7 Monitoring	Monthly data; incident reports	Monitoring report; interventions	Dashboard; incident form; alerts on cap breaches
8 Evaluation	Test data; KPIs; user outcomes	Evaluation report; regulatory findings	Report template; outcome capture
9 Exit	Evaluation; licence or permit status	Exit decision; register update; insight input	Register interface; follow-up surveys at 12 and 24 months

Total planning-assumption time from complete application to Committee decision for a Full Sandbox case is about 50 working days across stages 2-5, in the same range as MAS's reported median of about 3 months including applicant response time [S7]. EUz should publish the median it actually achieves.

5.3 Operating tracks: launch two, pilot two after the first cohort, defer one

Exhibit 10. Sandbox track comparison and sequencing

Track	What it is	International evidence	Legal feasibility (to verify)	Capacity need	Recommendation
1 Regulatory Guidance	Written regulatory position; no exemption	ICO exit reports [S5]; Ofgem 22 of 30 feedback-only [S6]	High: needs no exemption power; confirm services mandate	Low	**Launch on day 1**
2 Full Regulatory Sandbox	Capped live test with conditions; consent where needed	MAS 15 of 19 licensed [S7]; UK funding effect [S2]	Reported in law; scope of exemptions to verify [S27]	Medium	**Launch on day 1**, capped at three to four projects
3 Sandbox Express	Predefined low-risk categories with standard conditions	MAS target 21 days, attainment unpublished [S8]	Needs Council-approved standard conditions	Medium	**Pilot after month 6**, two categories
4 Regulation Prototyping	Test draft rules with participants before adoption	Japan reform cases (S) [S20]	Needs Council rule-making route; limited to EUz rules	Medium-high	**Pilot after month 9**, attached to completed tests
5 Cross-border Sandbox	One test across jurisdictions	GFIN: 0 of 8 began testing [S15]	Needs MoUs and partner regulators' consent	High	**Defer to year 2**; MoUs only in year 1

Reasoning. Evidence favours leading with the cheapest, best-evidenced tracks. Guidance outputs exist without legal exemptions, and the Full Sandbox is the track the reported EUz provisions most directly describe. Express needs data on what is genuinely low-risk, which only a first cohort supplies; MAS's own experience shows a faster or richer track can sit unused. Prototyping needs completed tests to prototype from. Cross-border tests failed in the only documented multi-regulator pilot and depend on counterparts EUz does not control.

5.4 Services provided to companies: a clear answer to "why EUz"

Singapore, the UK and the UAE already offer sandboxes with documented track records. EUz should not claim to outperform them on the evidence available. The credible proposition is narrower and has to be tested with prospective participants (Action 10, Section 8.1).

- **Emerging-technology scope in one place.** The best-evidenced sandboxes are mainly financial (MAS, DFSA, ADGM, SAMA). EUz can serve AI, data, trade technology and identity under one door, using the reported cross-sector mandate [S27] (A).
- **One jurisdiction for registration, testing and dispute resolution.** Reported features include English-law principles where necessary, English as working language and a commercial court in Tashkent [S27]. Whether this is attractive is a hypothesis to test (A).
- **A published decision clock and a named case manager.** MAS publishes a median but no Express attainment; EUz can publish both.
- **Reported tax and infrastructure benefits** [S27], subject to verification and secondary rules.

Exhibit 11. Services and when they should be available

Service	Day 1 (essential)	Later (differentiator)	Evidence or reason
Clear regulatory guidance, published positions	Yes		ICO, Ofgem [S5][S6]
Fast eligibility assessment	Yes: 10 WD screening (planning assumption)	Express decisions in 21 days	MAS target [S8]
Dedicated case manager	Yes		Single point of contact reduces hand-offs (A)
Defined testing conditions and safeguards	Yes		FCA tools; ICO limits [S1]
Controlled regulatory flexibility	Yes, for EUz-controlled requirements only	Extended through regulator consent protocols	Council powers to verify [S27]
Testing infrastructure, APIs, synthetic data	Minimum viable environment	Richer datasets, compute	FCA Digital Sandbox [S4]
Cybersecurity and privacy advisory	Yes, via expert roster	Standing lab	Risk in live tests (A)
International expert engagement	Peer review of rules	Standing advisory panel	WEF and others (Chapter 6)

Service	Day 1 (essential)	Later (differentiator)	Evidence or reason
Market-entry support and commercialisation pathway	Introductions to licensing bodies	Demo events, investor access	UK funding effect [S2]; Plus unused [S7]

5.5 Exit and graduation: successful testing does not automatically grant a licence

Exhibit 12. Exit routes

Route	When it applies	Decided by	Legal note (to verify)
Continue under existing rules	Test showed the activity is lawful without a licence	Committee, with regulator confirmation where relevant	Written confirmation; no EUz waiver of external rules
Apply for permanent licence or permit	Activity needs authorisation from EUz or a national regulator	The licensing authority, not the Committee	Committee evidence supports but does not bind the authority
Transition to revised regime	Test led to a new rule or standard	Council (EUz rules) or national bodies	Requires rule-making; may need amendments
Extension or further testing	Material evidence gap; legally permissible	Committee, within the Board-set term	Reported term of 12 months unless Board decides otherwise [S27]
Commercial expansion	Beyond the approved clients, territory or volume	Committee on new application	Admission gives no automatic launch right [S31]
Termination or corrective action	Breach, harm, stop-loss trigger, no longer eligible	Committee; enforcement under the Center's regime	Enforcement powers reportedly include warning, order, removal of benefits, sanctions, suspension [S31]

5.6 Legal fit-gap analysis: a checklist for counsel, not a legal opinion

Categories: **V** verify in official text; **R** needs secondary regulation; **N** needs a national regulator's approval; **A** may need amendment. "Existing basis" reflects press reports (S) or EUz working files (L), not official texts.

Exhibit 13. Legal fit-gap matrix

Proposed mechanism	Existing EUz basis (status)	Cat.	Additional action required	Responsible authority
Sandbox with temporary exemptions	Reported: sandbox with temporary exemptions from some statutory requirements; simplified licensing (S) [S27]. EUz file: Art. 39-43 (L, unverified) [S31]	V, R	Read text; define exemption classes in Sandbox Rules	Council; General Counsel
Test term up to 12 months	Reported: up to 12 months unless the Board sets another period (S) [S27]	V	Confirm; set track-specific terms	Council
Admission delegated to Sandbox Committee	EUz file: admission decided by the Governing Council; Art. 15-17 (L) [S31]	V, R	Confirm Council may delegate; else Council ratification by written procedure	Council; General Counsel
Guidance Track	Not found. Possible basis in services provisions, Art. 66-70 (L, unverified) [S31]	V, R	Confirm mandate; rule on effect of written positions	Council
Express standard conditions	Not found. Reported: Council approves key rules (S) [S27]	R	Council approves a standard-conditions schedule	Council
Flexibility on national requirements	EUz file: financial testing follows the competent regulator's decision (L) [S31]	N	Consent protocol per regulator; list of non-waivable requirements	National regulators; Council
Participant safeguards (caps, disclosure, redress, stop-loss)	Not found in sources reached	V, R	Include in Sandbox Rules; check against consumer and liability provisions	Council; General Counsel
Digital sandbox and synthetic data	Reported: participants access the Center's infrastructure (S) [S27]	V, N	Data-handling rules; check personal-data law	Administration; data authority
Regulation Prototyping	Not found	R, A	Council rule on prototyping notes; recommendations to national bodies	Council; national bodies
Registrar role in sandbox	EUz file: role not defined (L) [S31]	R	Define status recording and removal	Council; Registrar
Enforcement against participants	EUz file: Art. 78-79 warning to suspension (L) [S31]	V	Confirm application to sandbox participants	General Counsel
Dispute forum for test agreements	Reported: Tashkent International Commercial Court; a 2025 report said a separate court (discrepancy) (S) [S27]	V	Specify law and forum in test agreement	General Counsel
Coordination with existing national sandboxes and legal-experiment regimes	Reported: Central Bank Reg. 3391, PQ-255, PP-359 (S) [S29][S30]; Cabinet sandbox regime (2023) and Law on Legal Experiments (2026) (S) [S37][S38]	V, N	Read the texts; referral protocol; avoid dual admission; confirm how EUz tests relate to the 2026 law	Administration; Central Bank; NAPP; General Counsel

Proposed mechanism	Existing EUz basis (status)	Cat.	Additional action required	Responsible authority
Cross-border sandbox	Not found	A, N	MoUs; recognition of partner decisions	Council; counterpart regulators
Publication of case register and exit reports	Not found	R	Confidentiality and consent clauses	Council

5.7 Admission criteria and standard safeguards

Criteria are assessed by the Secretariat and decided by the Committee. They are a recommendation to be adopted in the Sandbox Rules, not a reported feature of the law.

Exhibit 14. Admission criteria and standard safeguards

Element	Standard	Why (evidence or reasoning)
Genuine innovation	Technology or business model is new to Uzbekistan or materially improves on what exists	MAS Plus found most applicants used technology already in Singapore [S7]
Need for testing	A specific regulatory uncertainty or barrier is identified; otherwise redirect to the Guidance Track	Ofgem: 22 of 30 had no specific barrier [S6]
User or economic benefit	Plausible benefit to users, trade or the data economy	Consumer-outcome gap in the UK evidence [S2]
Readiness	Working prototype, governance, security basics and resources to complete the test and meet exit conditions	DFSA exits depend on meeting full authorisation requirements [S14]
Priority fit	Falls within EUz's emerging-technology mandate	Scope reported in [S27]
Caps	Maximum clients, transaction value or volume, territory and term set in the decision	EUz working files: admission limited to product, clients, territory, term, volume [S31]
Disclosure and redress	Users told they are in a test; defined complaint and compensation route	FCA retained consumer safeguards in the sandbox [S1]
Stop-loss and incidents	Pre-agreed triggers; incident reporting to the Secretariat within two working days (planning assumption)	Risk control in live tests (A)
Data and cyber	Data-handling plan; synthetic data first where possible; security review by an expert	FCA Digital Sandbox model [S4]
Non-waivable core	A short list set with counsel and each regulator. Presumption: sanctions and financial-crime duties, core personal-data protections and safety-critical requirements are not waived	Recommendation (A); to be confirmed against official texts

5.8 How regulators, experts and technology companies interact

Exhibit 15. Engagement protocol across the participant lifecycle

Moment	Regulators	Independent experts	Technology company
Before application	Publish contact points and what they will and will not consent to	None	Uses Guidance Track and readiness checklist; speaks to a case manager
Regulatory mapping (stage 3)	Confirm which requirements are theirs and whether they would consent; written reply within an agreed period (set by MoU)	Advise on technical risk classification	Supplies product and data-flow descriptions
Test design (stage 4)	Agree conditions in their remit; may attend as observer	Review AI, cyber and privacy risk; propose test protocols	Co-designs scope, KPIs and exit evidence
Approval (stage 5)	Non-voting consent seat on the Committee for their matters	Two voting seats on the Committee	Presents; accepts conditions in writing
Testing and monitoring (6-7)	Receive incident notices in their remit; quarterly regulator forum	On call for incidents	Reports monthly; escalates incidents within two working days
Evaluation and exit (8-9)	Confirm exit route in their remit; co-sign insights where relevant	Review evaluation findings	Provides outcome data for 24 months (funding, licence status, survival)

A standing quarterly forum of participating national regulators, chaired by the Secretariat head, reviews live cases, consent turnaround and rule-change proposals. The European Blockchain Sandbox reports more than 50 regulators in its first cohort and annual recognition of regulators [S17]; EUz should aim at a much smaller, named group.

5.9 Launch sequence: what must work on day one and what can wait

Exhibit 16. Day-one capabilities and later additions

Capability	Day one	After month 6	After month 12	Basis
Guidance Track with published positions	Yes			ICO, Ofgem [S5][S6]
Full Sandbox, capped at three to four projects	Yes			Throughput evidence, Chapter 2
Sandbox Committee with independent experts	Yes			Section 5.1
Regulatory mapping memo and consent protocol	Yes			GFIN [S15]
Minimum digital platform: intake, case file, decision log	Yes			FCA Digital Sandbox [S4]
Synthetic-data test environment	For pilots P1 and P3	Extend to more domains		FCA evaluation [S4]
Published SLAs and quarterly attainment	SLAs published	Attainment reported		MAS reporting gap [S8]
Outcome tracking at 12 and 24 months	Clauses in test agreements	First survey	First annual report	BIS evidence [S2]
Express track		Pilot, two categories	Extend if attainment is met	MAS Express [S8]
Regulation Prototyping			Pilot (from month 9)	Japan [S20]
Investor and demo events		Yes	Annual programme	UK funding effect [S2]
Cross-border pilots and recognition	MoU discussions only	MoU discussions	First bilateral pilot if regulators agree	GFIN [S15]
Standing expert panel and advanced testing infrastructure			Yes, on evidence of demand	Long-term (Section 8.3)

5.10 Compact risk assessment

Exhibit 17. Principal risks (qualitative analyst judgement, not scored)

Risk	Evidence	Mitigation	Owner	Exposure
Legal basis narrower than assumed	Official texts not read for this report	Verification sprint; counsel opinion before rules	General Counsel	High
National regulators do not consent	GFIN: no test began [S15]	Consent protocol; start with pilots with a willing owner	Sandbox head	High
Low or mismatched demand	MAS Plus 0 approvals [S7]; Korea ICT decline [S23]	Demand interviews; two tracks first	Business development	Medium
Harm to users or data in live tests	Live tests carry real risk (A)	Caps; stop-loss; expert review; incident rule	Risk lead	Medium
Capacity overload	Ofgem w1: 30 EOIs for 3 sandboxes [S6]	Triage to Guidance Track; cap intake	Sandbox head	Medium
Weak selection weakens the signal	UK effect is a certification effect [S2]	Published criteria and reasons	Committee	Medium
Dependence on a single partner	WEF outputs self-reported (Chapter 6)	Define deliverables; keep decisions internal	International affairs	Medium

6. WEF partnership assessment: best used as convener and peer reviewer, not as design owner

Research caveat: weforum.org could not be opened directly. WEF facts below come from search summaries of WEF, UAE government and vendor pages, and all outcome claims are convener-reported (P). No independent evaluation of any WEF regulatory programme was found.

Exhibit 18. What WEF has actually delivered: documented record

Programme	Dates	WEF's role	Documented output	Evidence type
UAE TradeTech Regulatory Sandbox	MoU Jan 2024; preliminary findings Apr 2025; report 1 Oct 2025	Convener and publisher; UAE regulators supervised; vendor supplied platform	8 start-ups, 4 UAE regulators; themes: digital trade documents, SSI, stablecoin payments, DeFi lending [S10][S11][S32]	P (convener); per-firm outcomes not verified
Global Regulatory Innovation Platform (GRIP)	Signed Jan 2025; launched Jul 2025	Platform with UAE Cabinet General Secretariat	Planned over two years: Global Regulatory Playbook, Regulatory Future Readiness Index, Global Regulatory Innovation Hub (T). No delivered output, member list or fee model verified [S12]	T
Rwanda drone regulation; India drone toolkit	From 2017; Jan 2019	Partnership and open-source guide	Performance-based drone regulation in Rwanda; toolkit with an Andhra Pradesh pilot (WEF-reported) [S12]	P
Centre for the Fourth Industrial Revolution network	Impact report 2023-24	Network	Report exists; not read	Not verified

6.1 Four questions, answered from the evidence

1. **What has WEF delivered elsewhere?** Convening and publication, most concretely the TradeTech sandbox (8 start-ups, 4 UAE regulators) and earlier drone-regulation toolkits. WEF is not a regulator or licensing body, and its platform outputs (GRIP) were still in prospect as at this research [S11][S12].
2. **Which capabilities are relevant to EUz?** Convening regulators and companies across jurisdictions; multi-authority pilot coordination; published methodology that gives EUz's design an external reference; international visibility.
3. **What work products should EUz request?** A peer review of this operating model against the TradeTech experience; a structured introduction to a small number of regulators and companies; a pilot-design review for Pilot 2; and access to GRIP material when published. Each should have defined outputs, dates and a requirement to report outcomes and limitations.
4. **What could EUz do without WEF, and what needs a partner?** EUz can do benchmarking, rule drafting, case management, platform build, domestic regulator engagement and the first cohort alone. A partner genuinely adds independence of review, access to foreign regulators and companies, and a convener for multi-jurisdiction pilots.

Exhibit 19. Proposed WEF deliverables assessed against evidence

Proposed deliverable	Evidence of WEF capability	Assessment	Recommended stance
International benchmarking and design review	GRIP playbook planned, not delivered (T) [S12]	Weak evidence	Do not commission production; request review of this report's benchmarking
Operating-model peer review	Convening role in TradeTech [S11]	Moderate	**Request**: written review with named reviewers
Governance and risk framework	None found	No evidence	EUz and counsel draft; WEF reviews only
Initial pilot design support	TradeTech: 8 start-ups, 4 regulators [S11]	Moderate for multi-party trade pilots	**Request** for Pilot 2 only, with outcome reporting
Regulator and industry engagement	Convening record (Davos MoU, TradeTech Forum) [S10]	Moderate to strong	**Request**: introductions and a convened roundtable
Training and knowledge transfer	GRIP outputs not yet delivered [S12]	Not evidenced	Request only against defined content
International regulatory cooperation	Introductions, not agreements	Limited: regulators sign MoUs themselves	Direct regulator-to-regulator

Exhibit 20. Alternatives to WEF

Option	What it offers	Documented basis	Limits	Best use for EUz
WEF	Convening, publication, brand	TradeTech; GRIP (planned) [S11] [S12]	Self-reported results; no regulatory power	Peer review; convening; Pilot 2
Regulator-to-regulator (FCA, MAS, ADGM FSRA, DFSA, HKMA)	Operating knowledge, direct recognition	Documented programmes [S1][S7] [S13][S14][S21]	Mostly financial; capacity limits	Study visits; recognition MoUs
GFIN and similar networks	Cross-border application route	GFIN pilot: 44 applications, 0 tested [S15]	Membership terms for EUz not verified	Learning from failure; later option
Specialist consultants and counsel	Design, drafting, platform	Not evidenced here	Cost; independence	Rules, platform, legal verification
World Bank, OECD, UNCITRAL	Guides and standards	World Bank 73 sandboxes in 57 jurisdictions (2020) [S16]; OECD 2023 AI-sandbox paper [S26]; MLETR [S34]	General, not hands-on	Reference methods; MLETR alignment
Technology vendors	Test platforms	NayaOne in TradeTech (vendor-reported) [S32]	Commercial interest	Platform MVP through open tender

Conclusion

On documented capability, WEF is best suited to **international convening and peer review**, and conditionally to **pilot facilitation** for multi-party, multi-authority pilots such as TradeTech. The evidence does not support WEF as technical designer or governance owner. EUz should retain admission decisions, rules, risk management, regulator relations and data handling. Any engagement should fix deliverables, dates and a duty to report outcomes and limitations, and its fee model must be confirmed (not verified here).

7. First pilot portfolio: four pilots chosen from ten for measurable value and a realistic regulatory owner

Ratings are analyst judgement against the seven selection criteria and are not scores. No company or regulator named below is a committed partner; the participant lists describe the types needed.

Exhibit 21. Shortlist of ten pilot ideas

Pilot idea	Regulatory uncertainty	Commercial demand	Technical feasibility	Realistic regulatory owner	Resource need	Decision
1 AI agents and autonomous transactions	High	Medium (unverified)	Medium	Medium	Medium	**Selected: P1** (with 8)
2 AI-driven trade compliance	High	Medium	Medium	Medium	Medium	**Selected: P2** (with 5)
3 Cross-border digital identity	High	High (unverified)	Low	Low	High	Defer to year 2
4 Privacy-preserving data exchange	Medium-high	Medium	High	Medium	Medium	**Selected: P3**
5 Electronic transferable records	High	Medium	Medium	Medium	Low-medium	**Selected: P2** (with 2)
6 AI-based regulatory compliance	Medium	Medium	High	High (EUz itself)	Low	**Selected: P4**
7 Digital credentials	Medium	Medium	Medium-high	Medium	Medium	Defer; bundle with 3
8 Trusted AI testing	High	Medium	Medium	Medium	Medium	**Selected: P1** (with 1)
9 Data-economy infrastructure	High	Not evidenced	Low	Low	High	Defer
10 Autonomous systems (drones, robotaxis)	High	Reported interest (S) [S27]	Low	Low (physical safety bodies)	High	Watch item

P1 Assurance testing for AI agents that execute transactions

AI, autonomous systems | owner: Sandbox Committee with competent regulator as observer

Problem	Firms deploying AI agents that place orders, pay or contract lack clarity on attribution, authentication and evidence standards.
Regulatory barrier	No confirmed EUz position on attributing agent actions to a principal. EUz reportedly applies English common-law principles where necessary [S27]; their application to AI agents is untested (A).
Proposed experiment	Phase 1 on synthetic data with an independent red-team; phase 2 live, low-value business-to-business transactions with human-approval thresholds, full logging and a stop-loss.
Required participants	Two to three AI-agent developers; one or two enterprise buyers; an independent assurance provider; a competent-regulator observer.
Timeline	Design months 3-6; synthetic phase months 6-8; live phase months 8-12 (planning assumption).
Cost drivers	Test environment; independent assurance; legal drafting; case-manager time.
KPIs	Share of agent actions correctly attributed and logged; incidents and stop-loss triggers; time to resolve disputed actions; number of rules clarified.
Expected regulatory outcome	Published guidance on attribution, authentication and evidence; a candidate Council rule.

P2 Electronic trade documents with AI compliance screening

TradeTech | owner: lead authority named at design, with trade authorities as observers

Problem	Paper-based trade documents and manual compliance checks slow trade and raise error rates.
Regulatory barrier	Legal recognition of electronic transferable records and acceptance by trade authorities. Status of UNCITRAL MLETR-aligned law in Uzbekistan was not verified; Bahrain, Singapore and ADGM have adopted it [S34].
Proposed experiment	Issue and transfer electronic documents between EUz participants on a defined domestic route, with AI screening for completeness and sanctions flags; compare with manual process.
Required participants	A platform provider; one or two trading companies; a trade-finance provider; a customs or trade authority observer.
Timeline	Design months 3-6; test months 6-12.
Cost drivers	Platform integration; legal review; authority engagement.
KPIs	Processing time against participant-recorded baseline; error rate; number of authorities accepting electronic documents.
Expected regulatory outcome	Recognition guidance or rule; candidate bilateral MoU for later cross-border extension.

P3 Privacy-preserving data exchange with synthetic data

Data economy | owner: data-protection authority as observer, Administration as host

Problem	AI and data firms cannot access sensitive datasets to build and test products.
Regulatory barrier	Limits on secondary use and transfer under personal-data law (requirements not verified here) and no confirmed criteria for acceptable anonymisation.
Proposed experiment	A secure environment where data holders and developers run analytics using synthetic data or privacy-enhancing techniques; test re-identification risk independently.
Required participants	One or two data holders; developers; independent privacy assessor; authority observer.
Timeline	Design months 3-6; test months 6-12.
Cost drivers	Secure environment; synthetic-data generation; independent testing.
KPIs	Utility of outputs against a real-data baseline; re-identification test result; time to data access.
Expected regulatory outcome	Published technical and legal criteria for anonymisation and privacy-enhancing methods in the Center.

P4 AI-enabled regulatory reporting with EUz as regulator-in-the-loop

RegTech and GovTech | owner: EUz Administration

Problem	Onboarding and ongoing compliance reporting are manual for both participants and EUz.
Regulatory barrier	Mostly internal: rules on automated checks, explainability and human review. Low dependence on national regulators.
Proposed experiment	Participants file compliance reports by API; an AI tool pre-checks and flags issues; EUz staff review; compare with manual handling.
Required participants	Two RegTech providers; three to five Center participants; EUz Registrar and supervision staff.
Timeline	Design months 3-5; test months 6-11.
Cost drivers	Integration; staff time; model assessment.
KPIs	Review time per filing; false-positive rate; participant effort; reviewer overrides.
Expected regulatory outcome	Adoption decision and a Council rule on automated compliance checks. Fastest visible result because EUz owns the outcome.

8. Roadmap, KPIs and management decisions: a 90-day plan that fits the pre-commencement window

8.1 First 90 days: fifteen actions

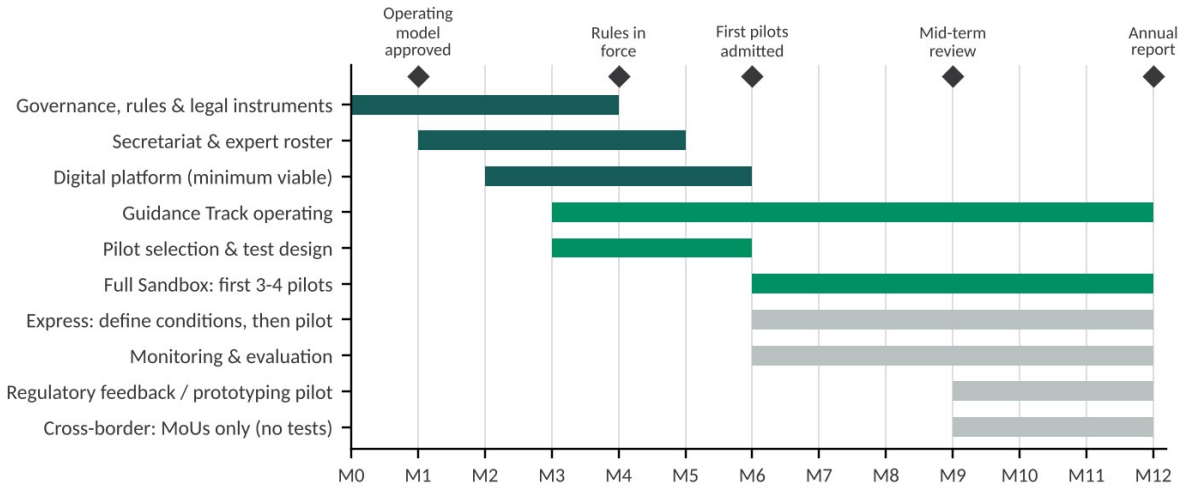
Day 0 is the date this report is accepted. If the Constitutional Law enters into force on 21 January 2027, as press reports state (S) [S27], the 90 days fall within the preparation period. Priorities: C = critical, H = high, M = medium.

Exhibit 22. 90-day action plan

#	Action	Function	Deliverable	Depends on	Pri.	Completion criterion
1	Obtain and read the official texts; verify sandbox provisions	General Counsel	Verified legal baseline memo	Access to texts	C	Memo signed; Section 5.6 updated
2	Confirm powers: delegation, Registrar role, exemption scope	General Counsel	Written opinion	1	C	Opinion issued
3	Council approves operating model and track sequencing	Executive Director; Council secretary	Council resolution	1, 2	C	Resolution adopted
4	Draft Sandbox Rules: eligibility, conditions, safeguards, exit, publication	General Counsel; Sandbox head	Draft rules for consultation	3	C	Draft published for comment
5	Appoint Sandbox head; recruit core team of about six (planning assumption)	Executive Director; HR	Named head; job specifications	3	H	Head in post; recruitment open
6	Establish expert roster and conflict policy	Sandbox head	Roster across AI, cyber, data, law	3	H	Roster approved (size set by need)
7	Identify competent national authorities per pilot; draft consent protocol	International affairs; counsel	Protocol template	2	H	Template agreed in principle with at least two authorities
8	Open the Guidance Track: public call and intake form	Sandbox head	Live intake	4	H	First guidance case logged
9	Scope digital platform MVP and sourcing route	Platform lead	Requirements; sourcing decision	3	H	Decision memo approved
10	Demand test: structured interviews with prospective participants	Business development	Demand report	None	M	Report delivered; proposition refined
11	Pilot shortlist workshop and selection of three to four pilots	Sandbox head	Selection memo	7, 10	H	Pilots and regulator owners named
12	Scope WEF and alternative support; request defined deliverables	International affairs	Scoping note and term sheet	3	M	Decision on engagement
13	KPI data dictionary and outcome-tracking clauses for test agreements	Sandbox head; analytics	Data dictionary; clause library	4	M	Dictionary approved
14	Risk and cyber framework: incident rule, stop-loss, data handling	Risk lead	Framework	4	H	Framework approved
15	Publish the EUz Sandbox prospectus (offer, SLAs, exclusions)	Communications	Prospectus v1	4, 11	M	Published

8.2 First 12 months: phased roadmap

Exhibit 23. 12-month implementation roadmap (month 0 = Council approval of the operating model)



Phase	Months	Focus	Exit criterion
1 Foundations	0-3	Operating model, rules, team, legal verification, regulator protocol	Rules drafted; head appointed; Guidance Track live
2 Soft launch	3-6	Guidance Track operating; pilot design; platform MVP; expert roster	Three to four pilots designed with regulator owners
3 Controlled launch	6-9	First pilots admitted and tested; monitoring; Express conditions drafted	Mid-term review (month 9)
4 Evaluate and extend	9-12	Express pilot; prototyping pilot; first insights report; MoU discussions	Annual report with KPI scorecard

8.3 Long-term development

After year one and subject to evidence: cross-border pilots under bilateral MoUs; recognition of partner regulators' test decisions; richer digital testing infrastructure; a standing advisory panel; and a regular regulatory-innovation programme for emerging technology. None should start before the first annual report shows demand, throughput and regulator cooperation.

8.4 KPIs: fourteen measures of actual success

EUz has no baseline yet. Targets below are described by approach, and any numerical target should be labelled a management planning assumption until the first cohort provides data.

Exhibit 24. KPI scorecard

KPI	Definition and measurement	Data source	Owner	Freq.	Target-setting approach
1 Time to decision (Full)	Median calendar days from complete application to Committee decision	Platform timestamps	Sandbox head	Monthly	Compare with published SLA; set after first ten decisions
2 Screening turnaround	Share of applications screened within SLA	Platform	Sandbox head	Monthly	Planning-assumption SLA 10 WD
3 Guidance response	Share of guidance cases closed with a written position within SLA	Case register	Regulatory counsel	Quarterly	Set after first 20 cases
4 Pilots launched	Number admitted that began testing	Case register	Sandbox head	Quarterly	Planning range three to four in year 1
5 Completion rate	Share of pilots finishing the term without termination	Case register	Committee	Per cohort	Benchmark: none reliable; set after cohort 1
6 Permanent-route conversion	Share of exited participants holding a permanent route within 12 months of exit	Exit survey; register	Committee	Annual	Compare with MAS 15 of 19 as context only
7 Regulatory issues resolved	Documented uncertainties closed by position, consent or rule	Position library	Regulatory counsel	Quarterly	Count; no target in year 1
8 Rules improved	Council-approved rule changes or guidance originating from tests	Council minutes	General Counsel	Annual	Count; aim that every pilot ends with a note

KPI	Definition and measurement	Data source	Owner	Freq.	Target-setting approach
9 Private investment	Funds raised by participants in 24 months after admission (participant-reported, documented)	Participant reports	Business development	Annual	Report only; no target
10 International companies attracted	Participants and applicants headquartered outside Uzbekistan	Application data	Business development	Quarterly	Set after demand test
11 Cross-border experiments	Completed multi-jurisdiction tests	Case register	International affairs	Annual	Zero expected in year 1
12 Participant satisfaction	Mean rating on a five-point scale after exit	Survey	Sandbox head	Per cohort	Trend over cohorts
13 Cost and time savings	Participant-estimated saving against baseline recorded at admission (label: estimate)	Participant reports	Sandbox head	Per cohort	Report only; never extrapolate
14 Harm incidents	Material incidents and stop-loss triggers per active pilot	Incident log	Risk lead	Monthly	Threshold set in risk framework

8.5 Management decision matrix

Exhibit 25. Decisions required to launch the institution

#	Decision	Recommended option	Alternatives considered	Owner	By
D1	Operating model and track sequencing	Two tracks at launch; Express after month 6; Prototyping after month 9; Cross-border year 2	All five tracks at launch; financial-only scope	Council	Day 30
D2	Admission authority	Delegate to Sandbox Committee if counsel confirms; otherwise Council on a written procedure	Council decides every case	Council	Day 30
D3	Secretariat and budget	Named head and core team of about six; budget to be sized	Outsource the function; part-time unit	Executive Director	Day 45
D4	Legal verification and rules	Counsel reads official texts, then drafts Sandbox Rules	Draft rules first and check later	General Counsel	Day 20
D5	Safeguards and non-waivable list	Caps, disclosure, redress, stop-loss, incident rule on every test	Case-by-case safeguards	Council	Day 60
D6	Pilot portfolio	Four pilots P1-P4 with named regulator owners	Wider portfolio; single flagship pilot	Sandbox head; Committee	Day 75
D7	Digital platform	Minimum viable platform; open tender; synthetic data first	Build full platform; no platform	Platform lead	Day 60
D8	International partner scope	WEF for convening and peer review; direct regulator MoUs; counsel for drafting	WEF as design lead; no partner	International affairs	Day 75
D9	Publication policy	Publish SLAs, attainment, case register (anonymised), exit and insight reports	Publish annual summary only	Council	Day 60
D10	KPI framework	Adopt Section 8.4 scorecard; baselines after cohort 1	Targets fixed now	Executive Director	Day 75

Annex A. Extended benchmarking matrix

Status: **L** = legally established; **O** = operational; **A** = announced. All figures as reported by the cited source, primary page not opened. "Not verified" = no figure found.

Programme	Launch	Status	Documented figures and notes	Src
UK FCA Sandbox	2016	O	629 applied, 172 accepted to Dec 2023; AI Live Testing cohort 1 Dec 2025 (outcomes pending)	S1 S3 S33
UK FCA Digital Sandbox	2020	O (pilots)	28 organisations in two pilots; permanent status not verified	S4
UK ICO Sandbox	2019	O	10 chosen of about 64-65; statutory option found feasible (S, Jul 2026)	S5
UK Ofgem Sandbox	2016-17	O	Window 1: 30 EOIs, 3 sandboxes, 22 feedback only; later counts not verified	S6
Singapore MAS Sandbox, Express, Plus	2016; 2019; 2022	O	15 of 19 graduated; median about 3 months; Plus 0 approvals; Express target 21 days	S7-S9
UAE ADGM RegLab	2016	O	26 admitted of 69 to Sep 2018; later not verified	S13
UAE DFSA ITL	2017	O	105 applicants, 51 accepted, 3 exited (Jun 2021); 130 and 67 hosted (Jul 2022)	S14
WEF-UAE TradeTech	2024	O (report issued)	8 start-ups, 4 UAE regulators (P); outcomes not verified	S10 S11
GFIN cross-border pilot	2018-20	O (concluded)	44 applications, 17 regulators, 8 shortlisted, none tested	S15
European Blockchain Sandbox	2023	O (2023-26)	87 applied, 20 admitted, >50 regulators (cohort 1); 60 use cases overall	S17
EU AI Act sandboxes (Arts 57-59)	Law 2024	L; deadline moved to 2 Aug 2027 (S)	Spain pilot closed 12 Jun 2026: 11 systems completed (12 selected of 44 per secondary sources); implementing act not verified	S18 S19
Japan cross-sector sandbox	2018	L (permanent 2021)	33 plans, 152 entities, Mar 2025; reform count not verified	S20
HKMA FSS and GenAI sandbox	2016; 2024	O	FSS 234 initiatives to end-2021; GenAI 15, 27, 36 use cases	S21
Saudi SAMA sandbox	2018	O	45 permitted, 18 graduated (May 2023); 25 operating (Sep 2025, stock)	S22
South Korea financial sandbox	2019	L	>300 designations (Mar 2024) vs 1,072 (Jun 2026 press): unreconciled	S23
South Korea ICT convergence	2019	L	2019: 278 received, 195 approved; applications fell 110 to 67 over two years (S)	S23
Australia ASIC enhanced sandbox	2020	L/O	103 applied, 19 accepted; 1 licence among 16 exits (press account of review)	S24
Canada CSA / OSC LaunchPad	2017	O	Participant counts not verified	-
Bahrain CBB sandbox	2017	O	About 35 admitted, 2 graduates (2019 reports); newer data not verified	S25
Qatar QCB sandbox	2024 (BNPL)	O	First BNPL cohort 5 firms (Apr 2024); QFC counts not verified	S35
AIFC (Kazakhstan) FinTech Lab	n/v	O	First graduate to full licence reported 2022; totals not verified	S36
Uzbekistan Central Bank sandbox	Reg. 3391, Oct 2022	L; update announced	Up to three years; three-track draft; upgrade planned 2026-27 (S)	S29
Uzbekistan capital-markets sandbox	PQ-255, Oct 2025	L	1 Oct 2025 to 1 Oct 2026; five firms added Jun 2026 (S)	S30
Uzbekistan Cabinet regulatory sandbox regime	Nov 2023	L (reported)	Procedure and temporary regulation for legal-entity businesses testing technology-based goods and services; ministries named include digital, transport, investment, industry and trade, agriculture and construction (S; text not read)	S37
Uzbekistan Law on Legal Experiments	27 Mar 2026	L (reported)	Legal experiments of 6 months to 3 years, with a unified register; may not restrict constitutional rights (S; text not read)	S38

Annex B. Unreconciled and unverified data points

Item	Conflict or gap	Treatment
FCA per-cohort figures	Counts differ across sources (e.g. cohort 1: 69 applications / 24 accepted vs other splits; Deloitte split does not match the FCA's 50 accepted)	Only FCA 2017 report totals and FCA FOI totals used
MAS 19 accepted	Unclear whether the figure spans standard, Express and Plus	Quoted with that caveat
TradeTech regulators	WEF Oct 2025 says 4; a later WEF report lists more bodies	Both shown; flagged
Spain AI sandbox	11 completed (official release) vs 12 selected from 44 (secondary)	Both shown; flagged
Korea designations	>300 (FSC, Mar 2024) vs 1,072 (press, Jun 2026)	Both shown; not used as headline

Item	Conflict or gap	Treatment
Dates of EU AI Omnibus	Law-firm notes give publication 24 Jul 2026 and Regulation (EU) 2026/1744; not confirmed in EUR-Lex	Described as secondary-source
Constitutional Law signing date	Reported as 16, 19 and 21 August 2026; number not found	Month only; entry into force 21 Jan 2027 is press-reported
Tax and court details	Personal income tax 7% vs 7.5%; separate opt-in court (2025) vs Tashkent International Commercial Court (2026)	Not relied upon
BIS WP 901 authorship	Authors are Cornelli, Doerr, Gambacorta and Merrouche (the research brief named different authors)	Corrected in citations
Post-2018 ADGM; post-2022 DFSA; Canada; QFC; AIFC totals; HKMA FSS after 2021; Japan reform count; GRIP outputs; MLETR enactments	No reliable figure found	Marked "Not verified"

Annex C. Legal references and verification status

Instrument	What is reported	Status in this research
Presidential Decree UP-233, 26 Nov 2025, "On organisation of the activity of the International Centre for Digital Technologies"	Listed on lex.uz (title, date, number); press says it set up Enterprise Uzbekistan on English and Welsh common law principles [S28][S27]	Listing seen in search; **text not read**
Constitutional Law on the International Centre for Digital Technologies	Press: Senate approval 7 Aug 2026; signed Aug 2026; in force 21 Jan 2027; special regime to 2100; sandbox of up to 12 months, temporary exemptions, simplified licensing [S27]	Press only; **official text and number not found**
Tashkent International Financial Centre law LRU-1158 (13 Jul 2026)	A separate law for a different centre	Not to be conflated
EUz working files (Registrar map)	Article map: Art. 15-17 Council; 22-23 residents; 39-43 sandbox; 66-70 services; 74-75 AI; 78-79 enforcement; Operating Regulations dated 31 Aug 2026 [S31]	Draft, unverified
Central Bank Regulation 3391 (4 Oct 2022); PQ-255; PP-359 (27 Nov 2025); UP-35 (5 Mar 2026, pharma sandbox)	Existing national sandbox and pilot regimes [S29][S30]	Press and law-firm reports; not read
Cabinet of Ministers decision on regulatory sandbox for businesses (Nov 2023); Law on Legal Experiments (27 Mar 2026)	Press: a Cabinet regime for testing technology-based goods and services, and a general law on legal experiments with a unified register [S37][S38]	Press only; **texts and numbers not read**; relation to EUz not established

Legally confirmed EUz powers: **none confirmed in this research.** Powers requiring secondary regulation (reported): registration, licensing, sandbox procedures. Activities needing national-regulator approval (EUz working files): financial-product testing. Mechanisms that may need amendment: cross-border tests, Regulation Prototyping beyond EUz's own rules.

Annex D. Verification plan before external use

1. Open and read lex.uz texts of UP-233 and the Constitutional Law; confirm Art. 39-43, the 12-month term, Council powers of delegation and the Registrar's role; check how EUz tests relate to the national Law on Legal Experiments (2026); update Section 5.6.
2. Open each primary source for figures quoted in headline tiles and the scorecard: MAS reply (S7), FCA reports and FOI (S1, S3), BIS WP 901 (S2), GFIN report (S15), HKMA releases (S21), WEF report (S11).
3. Reconcile the items in Annex B; where a conflict persists, drop the figure from external materials.
4. Check EUR-Lex for the AI Omnibus number and dates, and for the sandbox implementing act.
5. Obtain GRIP terms and any fee model from WEF in writing; request per-participant TradeTech outcomes.
6. Complete the demand test (Action 10) before the proposition in Section 5.4 is used in marketing.

Annex E. Bibliography

Codes match citations in the text. URLs are the primary or cited pages; none was opened in full during this research (see evidence-status note).

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